

triggered a by-election in his Lok Sabha constituency of Karimnagar, claiming provocation from Congress MLA M. Satyanarayana Rao and citing delay in the formation of Telangana state, as promised by Congress in its 2004 manifesto.^[26] He won the subsequent by-election with a strong majority.^[27] All TRS MLAs and MPs resigned their positions in April 2008 when the Central government did not meet their demand for a separate state in its latest budget session.^[28] The by-election was held on 29 May 2008. In the 2008 by-elections, TRS retained only seven out of the 16 assembly segments and two out of the four Lok Sabha segments that it resigned, a significant defeat for the party.^{[29][30]} TRS president K. Chandrasekhara Rao offered to resign after the by-election losses, but instead remained in office after other party leaders rejected the resignation.^[30]

2009 elections

In 2009, TRS formed an alliance with TDP and joined the Bharatiya Janata Party-led National Democratic Alliance.^[31] The party contested 45 assembly and nine parliament seats to win only ten assembly and two parliament seats. This was considered another major defeat.

2014 elections

In the 2014 Assembly and National Elections, TRS did not align with NDA or UPA and fought the elections on its own. TRS, which led the campaign for a separate State for more than a decade, emerged victorious by winning 11 of the 17 Lok Sabha seats and 63 of the 119 Assembly seats, and emerged as the party with the largest vote share in Telangana. The TRS' campaign had no other stars except KCR who addressed over 300 public meetings, heli-hopping around and often addressing more than 10 meetings in a single day. The TRS not only retained its north Telangana stronghold but also made inroads in south Telangana, a Congress bastion.^[32]

It was only after the bifurcation of Andhra Pradesh, and the creation of separate Telangana state that the party begun to deliver electoral success. TRS won 63 out of 110 seats it contested in the 2014 Assembly elections in the newly formed state, and went on to form the government.^[33] K. Chandrashekar Rao, had taken oath as the first Chief Minister of the new state of Telangana on 2 June 2014.

2018 Telangana Legislative Assembly election

The TRS Government headed by Chief Minister K. Chandrasekhara Rao on 6 September 2018 dissolved the Legislative Assembly, the first after the formation of Telangana, to pave the way for early elections in the state.^[34] The party announced a list of 104 candidates for elections on the same day.^[35]

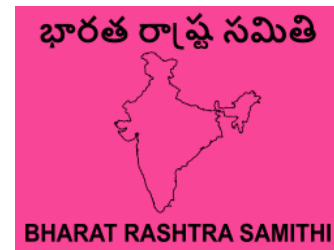
In the 2018 Telangana Legislative Assembly election, held three months after the house dissolution, the TRS party won with a massive majority. They won 88 seats, more than 70% of the 119 total.^[33]

2019 Indian general election

In May 2019, TRS Chief Rao flouted the idea of Federal Front, aiming for a non-Congress and non-BJP government at the centre.^[36] The party won nine out of the contested 17 seats, a reduction of two seats from the 2014 election.^[37]

Seats in Telangana Legislative Council	18 / 40
Seats in Telangana Legislative Assembly	27 / 119
Number of states and union territories in government	0 / 31

Party flag



Website

<https://brsonline.in/>

Politics of India · Political parties · Elections



Flag of Telangana Rashtra Samithi



Logo in use under the party's original name

2022-present: Name change, electoral setbacks

Bharat Rashtra Samithi

The name of the party was changed from *Telangana Rashtra Samithi* to *Bharat Rashtra Samithi* on 5 October 2022 to foray into national politics ahead of the [2024 Indian general election](#).^{[19][20]} On 6 October 2022, officials from BRS submitted the relevant documents required for name change according to the [Representation of the People Act, 1951](#) to the Election Commission of India in New Delhi.^[38] As of October 2022, the party activities are taking place from a rented building at Sardar Patel Marg in [Delhi](#). On 14 November the party office was inaugurated at [New Delhi](#).^{[39][40]}

Andhra Pradesh unit

The party created its local unit in the residual Andhra Pradesh state on 2 January 2023. Dr. Thota Chandrasekhar, former general secretary of the [Jana Sena Party](#), was named its president. Other leaders from Andhra Pradesh who joined the party on the on its state unit's formation include former minister [Ravela Kishore Babu](#), former IRS official Partha Sarathi, and former [Praja Rajyam Party](#) leader T. J. Prakash.^{[41][42]}

The state unit suffered a setback in April 2023 when the [Election Commission of India](#) derecognised the BRS as a state party in Andhra Pradesh. The party had been enjoying state party status in [Undivided Andhra Pradesh](#) since 2004, and then in the states of residual Andhra Pradesh and Telangana since 2014.^[43]



Prof Jayashankar Statue in Telangana Bhavan, TRS State Office

2023 Telangana Legislative Assembly election

At the 2023 Telangana Legislative Assembly election, the party lost their majority, with their vote share falling by 10.52% to 37.35% and their seat count falling from 88 to 39. They retained their seats in the Greater Hyderabad region, but lost most of their seats in the rest of the state to [Congress](#), who won 64 seats and formed the next government.

2024 Indian general election

The party suffered a further setback at the [2024 Indian General Election](#). Despite their previous national ambitions, the party only contested in [Telangana](#). However, they were wiped out, losing all 9 of their seats in the state. The party's vote share was over cut in half from 41.71% to 16.68%.

Legislative leaders

List of chief ministers

Chief Minister of Telangana

No.	Portrait	Name (Birth–Death)	Term in office			Assembly	Constituency	Ministry
			Assumed office	Left office	Time in office			
1		K. Chandrashekar Rao (b. 1954)	2 June 2014	12 December 2018	9 years, 188 days	1st	Gajwel	Rao I
			13 December 2018	6 December 2023		2nd		Rao II

Deputy Chief Ministers of Telangana

S.No.	Name	Portrait	Took office	Left office	Term	Chief Minister
1	<u>M. Mahmood Ali</u>		2 June 2014 ^[44]	12 December 2018	4 years, 193 days	<u>K. Chandrashekar Rao</u>
2	<u>T. Rajaiah</u>		2 June 2014	25 January 2015 ^[45]	237 days	
3	<u>Kadiyam Srihari</u>		25 January 2015 ^[46]	12 December 2018	3 years, 321 days	

List of Union Ministers

No.	Image	Minister	Portfolio	Term in Office			Constituency (House)	Prime Minister
				Assumed Office	Left Office	Time in Office		
1		K. Chandrashekar Rao (1954–)	<u>Minister of Shipping</u>	23 May 2004	25 May 2004	2 days	<u>Karimnagar</u> (Lok Sabha)	<u>Manmohan Singh</u> (<i>Manmohan I</i>)
			<u>Minister without Portfolio</u>	25 May 2004	27 November 2004	186 days		
			<u>Minister of Labour and Employment</u>	27 November 2004	24 August 2006	1 year, 270 days		
2		Ale Narendra (1946–2014)	<u>Minister of Rural Development</u> (<i>Minister of State</i>)	23 May 2004	24 August 2006	2 years, 93 days	<u>Medak</u> (Lok Sabha)	

Leadership

List of presidents

S.No.	Portrait	Name	Term (tenure length)	Duration	Ref.	1				
							<u>K. Chandrashekar Rao</u>	27 April 2001 – <i>Incumbent</i>	24 years, 6 months and 17 days	

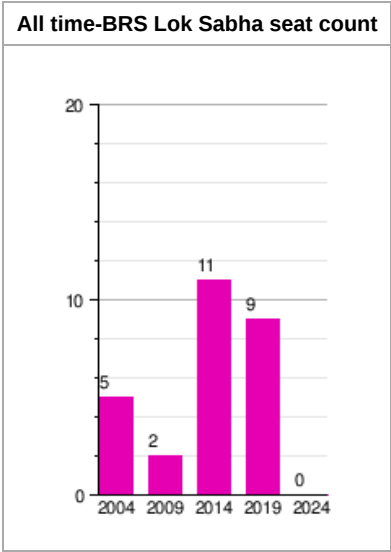
List of working presidents

S.No.	Portrait	Name	Term (tenure length)	Duration	Ref.	1				
							<u>K. T. Rama Rao</u>	15 December 2018 – <i>Incumbent</i>	6 years, 10 months and 29 days	^[47]

Electoral performance

Lok Sabha Election

Election Year	House term	Party leader	Seats contested	Seats won	Change in seats	Popular vote	Percentage of votes	Vote swing	Outcome	Ref.
2004	14th	K. Chandrashekar Rao	12	5 / 543	▲5	2,441,405	0.63%	— new	Government	[48]
2009	15th		9	2 / 543	▼3	2,582,326	0.62%	▼0.01%	Others	[49]
2014	16th		17	11 / 543	▲9	6,736,270	1.22%	▲0.6%	Others	[49]
2019	17th		17	9 / 543	▼2	7,696,848	1.25%	▲0.03%	Others	[37]
2024	18th		17	0 / 543	▼11	3,657,237	0.57%	▼0.68%	Lost	[37]



Vote share in consecutive Lok Sabha elections		
2004		0.63%
2009		0.61%
2014		1.22%
2019		1.25%
2024		1.22%

State Legislative Assembly elections

Election Year	House term	Party leader	Seats contested	Seats won	Change in seats	Popular vote	Percentage of votes	Vote swing	Outcome	Ref.
United Andhra Pradesh Legislative Assembly										
2004		K. Chandrashekar Rao	54	26 / 294	▲ 26	2,390,940	6.68%	— new	Government	^[50]
2009			45	10 / 294	▼ 16	1,678,906	3.99%	▼ 2.69%	Others	^[51]
2014			119	63 / 119	▲ 53	6,620,326	13.68%		Government ^[a]	^[52]
Telangana Legislative Assembly										
2018		K. Chandrashekar Rao	119	88 / 119	▲ 25	9,700,479	46.9%		Government	^[33]
2023			119	39 / 119	▼ 49	8,753,924	37.35%	▼ 9.55%	Opposition	^[53]

See also

- [Jaya Jaya He Telangana](#)
- [All India Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen](#)
- [Telangana Jagarana Sena](#)
- [List of political parties in India](#)

Notes

- a. Outcome-Government is restricted to Telangana

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